Case study by Chandana Vishnu Jayanth · vishnuatgit.github.io · jayanthvishnu9@gmail.com
Live demo: deepbell.onrender.com · Code: github.com/vishnuatgit/DeepBell

DeepBell

A mini SRE lab in FastAPI: it detects anomalies in its own CPU and memory, writes incident reports and restores from snapshots.

YEAR

2026

BUILT WITH

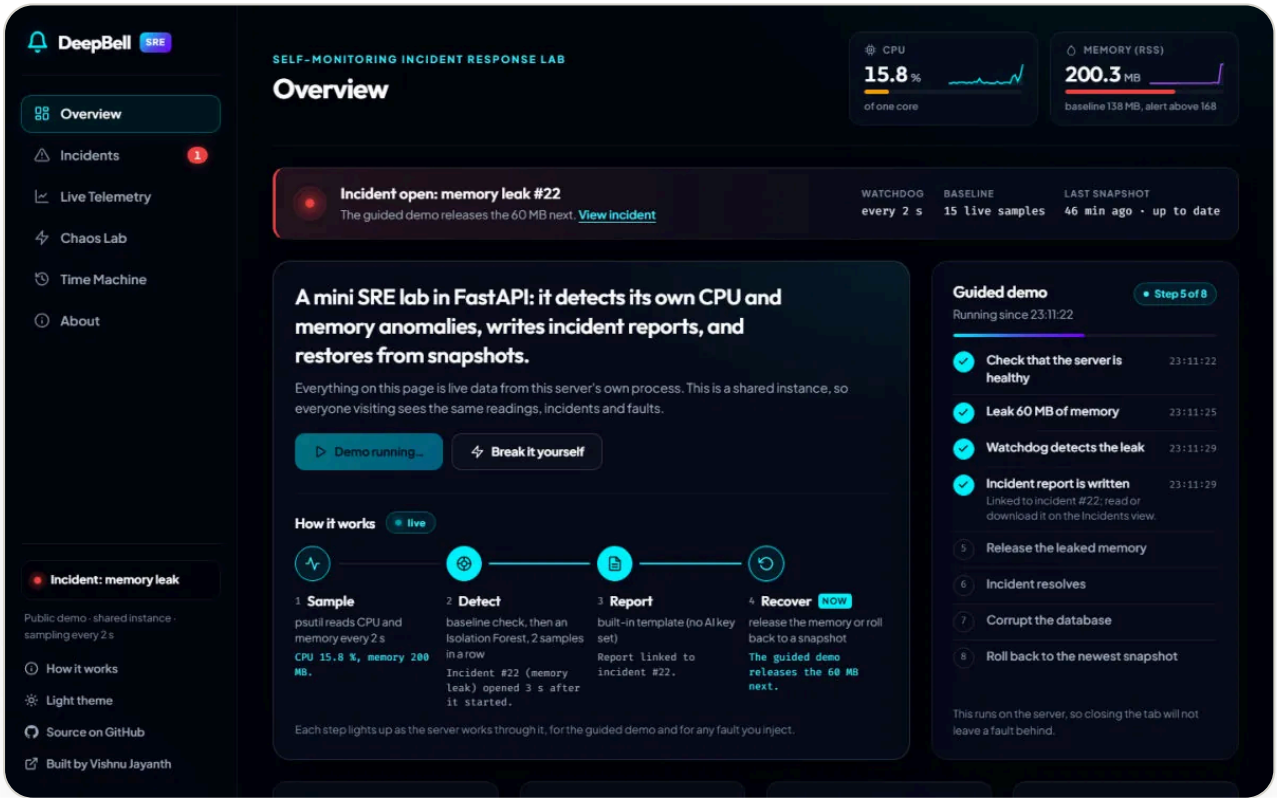
FastAPI · LangChain · Docker

PROOF

- 89 tests · CI passing

SOURCE

github.com/vishnuatgit/DeepBell



(01) The problem

WHY IT EXISTS

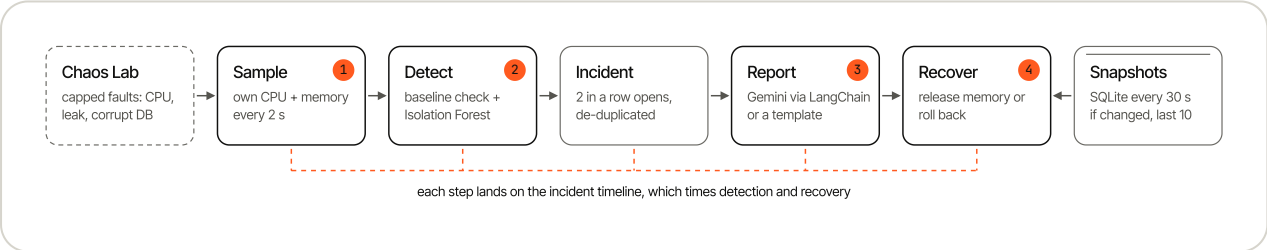
Monitoring usually stops at an alert. DeepBell practises *the steps after it.*

Detect, report, recover. Background threads sample the service's own CPU and memory every 2 s, a baseline check plus an Isolation Forest flags anomalies and opens de-duplicated incidents, each incident gets a written report, and rolling SQLite snapshots give one-click rollback.

A capped fault-injection lab (the Chaos Lab) lets you break it on purpose, and every incident records when it started, was detected and resolved, so detection and recovery are timed.

(02) How it works

FROM THE README



1 **Sample.** Every 2 s the watchdog reads the process's CPU % and resident memory with `psutil` and stores the sample.

2 **Detect.** The detector scores the sample. Two anomalous samples in a row open an incident; three normal ones close it. A query every 2 s catches a corrupted database.

3 **Report.** Opening an incident starts a report in a background thread: Google Gemini through LangChain when a key is configured, a built-in template otherwise.

4 **Recover.** Releasing the leaked memory lets the samples return to the baseline, which closes the incident; restoring a snapshot makes the database readable again.

(03) Key decisions

5 CHOICES

01 A baseline check first, the forest second

A sample is a candidate only when CPU is at least 15 points above the baseline or memory at least 30 MB above it; an Isolation Forest (100 trees) must then confirm it. On its own, the forest flagged ordinary jitter.

02 One incident per fault, never a new normal

Two anomalous samples open an incident and three normal ones close it, with one incident and one report per fault kind at a time. While an incident is open its samples stay out of the baseline, so a held leak never becomes the new normal.

03 AI reports with a built-in fallback

Reports come from Gemini through LangChain when a key is set, and from a deterministic template otherwise or when the call fails. Every report is labelled with what wrote it.

04 Snapshots kept apart from incident history

The SQLite database is copied every 30 s when it changed (newest 10 kept, each integrity-checked). Incident history lives in a separate `metrics.db`, so corrupting or rolling back the app database never rewrites it.

05 Safe to break in public

Every fault has caps and a cooldown: a CPU spike lasts 1 to 5 s, a leak holds at most 120 MB and is freed after 5 minutes, and a request during a cooldown gets a `429` with `Retry-After`. Public demo mode turns off the crash fault and the API-key endpoint.

(04) Proof

TESTS · CI · STACK

89	Passing	2 s
PYTEST TESTS, NO NETWORK, GEMINI STUBBED	CI ON PYTHON 3.11 AND 3.12, WITH A DOCKER BUILD	BETWEEN SAMPLES OF ITS OWN CPU AND MEMORY

The tests use temporary directories, disable the background threads or drive them with a fake clock, and replace the Gemini call with stubs. In six local runs of the guided demo, the leak was detected 2 to 4 s after it was injected and resolved 10 to 13 s after detection (demo measurements on a laptop, not production numbers).
CI runs ↗

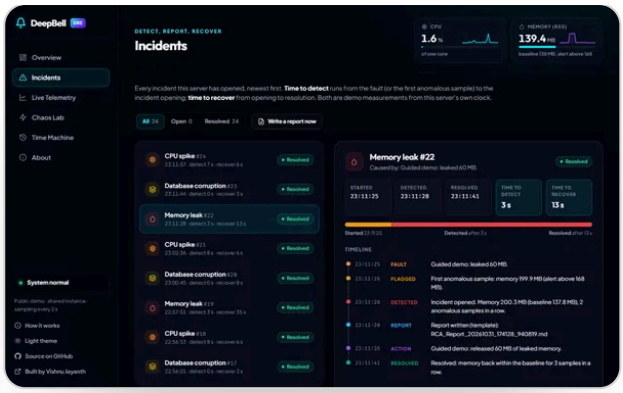
`Python 3.11, 3.12` `FastAPI` `Uvicorn` `SQLite` `psutil` `scikit-learn` `NumPy` `LangChain` `Google Gemini API` `Jinja2` `Chart.js` `pytest` `Ruff` `Docker` `GitHub Actions`

(05) Screenshots

FROM THE REPOSITORY



The overview: CPU and memory against the learned baseline, with incidents shaded.



An incident: time to detect, time to recover and its timeline.

(06) Limitations

HONESTLY

- **It monitors only itself**, on two signals (CPU and resident memory). It is a lab for the detect, report, recover loop, not a general monitoring tool.
- **Fixed minimum deviations** (15 CPU points, 30 MB), so smaller spikes and slow leaks are deliberately ignored.
- **Snapshots are not point-in-time recovery:** you can restore one of the last 10, taken at most every 30 s, and a rollback loses whatever changed since.
- **No authentication.** Public demo mode disables the dangerous endpoints and caps the rest, but any visitor can inject the capped faults.
- **Single worker.** Open incidents, cooldowns and leaked memory live in one process, and the measured times say nothing about a production system.

NEXT CASE STUDY

SupplyTrace ↗

A modular pipeline that ingests raw XML invoices, validates them with deterministic rules and compiles standardized feature matrices, with an experimental ML risk score.